

Question 23 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Describe training as an HRD subsystem and explain how it contributes to employee development.

Answer

Training is a planned organisational effort to help employees learn job-related competencies. Within HRD it is one subsystem, linked to needs from appraisal and to career/potential plans.

- 1. Need-based learning:** Training should follow TNA so it develops real deficiencies, not generic topics.
- 2. Skill, knowledge and attitude:** It contributes at all three levels required for role performance.
- 3. Present-job effectiveness:** Improves current performance (training need = standard – actual).
- 4. Preparation for change:** New technology, quality systems and products require training as a development tool.
- 5. Confidence and morale:** Mastery experiences increase self-efficacy and job satisfaction.
- 6. Link to career:** Training for future roles (e.g., supervisory skills) is developmental, not only remedial.
- 7. Socialisation:** Induction training develops organisational understanding and culture fit.
- 8. Limits:** Training alone does not develop people if climate, appraisal and job design do not allow transfer—hence it must stay a subsystem, not the whole HRD.

Conclusion. *Training contributes to employee development by systematically building competencies, provided it is integrated with other HRD subsystems.*